generated (or can be generated) at a tremendous pace. By itself it will not revolutionize the world and nor is it the answer to world hunger and bring about world peace and all those other ideals that we ascribe to it. Think of it this way, the fact that Wikipedia exists doesn't mean you're a genius, especially if you're spending all your time tweeting selfies and commenting on random posts.

## Make Big Data work for you

Does Big Data have the potential for ending world hunger? Of course it does. Will it? Of course not. It'll take someone like you to access that vast data archive, calculate the amount of food produced, the amount of food wasted, the most efficient method of distribution and all that sort of thing. Quite a task.

Essentially, to make Big Data work for you, one must learn to sieve through it and find what one is looking for. You need to ask the right question, or, as Christopher J. Frank (of American Express) puts it, the IWIK (I Wish I Knew) approach. We can explain this better with a simple case study.

## Case Study No.1 (Shoes)

Suppose you're a manufacturer of shoes (Nike, BATA, Woodland, take your pick). Randomly creating shoes based on trends that you observe is good enough in itself. You can obviously predict something as obvious as rain shoes for the rainy season, airy sandals for summer and so on, but it's something that anyone with a half a brain can predict. How do you do something more?

I Wish I Knew what my customers do with their shoes: How else will you know what shoes to make? The easiest, but most expensive method would be to contact Google and try to extract Google Now data from them or you can try to build your own app. What app do you build? You build one that offers something to your consumer, not just something that'll serve your needs.

Say you build a fitness app, something that just tracks footsteps. This will give you data on how much time people spend walking, jogging or running. But what if you take that one step further, what if you start tracking locations, figuring out the route that your app user takes? What if you could collate that data and figure out popular jogging locations or walking routes?

Shoes of all shapes and sizes, can Big Data recommend the perfect one for you?

What if you could offer that data to the user in exchange for a little bit of information, such as the type of shoes they wear and when? Extrapolating further, you could ask a user if they take a dog with them, suggest routes exclusively for dog users. Before long you'll have an entire army of joggers using your app, relying on you for information on where and when to jog and each and every one of them just pouring data into your servers at an alarming rate.

Taking this even further, suppose you start monitoring the age of your user, his health with the heart-rate monitor on his phone or wrist-strap or whatever. You can alert that person when something is going wrong, or he's not exerting himself enough and should jog faster. You can use this data to create better suited shoes and sell them to that user (knee friendly shoes for elderly grandmas for, example).

What you've achieved with this simple app is a dedicated audience, discovered the habits of your user, the terrain they run on, their average speed, the average distance covered, and so much more. It's even within the realms of possibility to offer customised shoes to every user.

You don't even have to stop at shoes, you can start your own line of accessories, restaurants, offer your data to advertisers, create a dating app that matches users with similar stats; the possibilities are endless and the potential for making money just as endless.

With one question that set everything in motion and assuming that you've implemented everything well and that the idea was accepted and embraced by the population as a whole, you've generated data on all the following:

- The type of people who buy your shoes
- The age group of said people
- The health of such people
- The terrain they run on
- The kind of shoes they wear
- The amount of time and the fashion in which the shoes are used
- The music they listen to while jogging
- The days and times that people jog and more.

### THE BIG BUST

As the average consumer, when you see Big Data all you see is magic; nay, not even that, you take it for granted that it will work, that it should work. You don't see the amount of effort that went into the collection and analysis of the data. You don't see the data that was gathered or the massive number crunching that goes on, and that's the beauty of Big Data when it's used correctly.

What's also disturbing at the same time is the fact that we're so accustomed to it, that we'd rather ignore a terrorist embracing Street View as an invaluable tool for organizing an attack and still rather have the convenience of Street View than live without it.